Service or product company analyst? Pick right.

01 Who you work for

Service company

- A client, through your company
- e.g. TCS, Infosys, Accenture

→ **Projects change with the client.**

VS

Product company

- Your own company's app or product
- e.g. Swiggy, Flipkart, Zerodha

→ **Same product, deeper every month.**

02

Same table, different question

Service company

✓ Client wants the monthly report by region

```
SELECT region, SUM(amount) FROM orders GROUP BY
region;
```

→ **Deliver what was asked.**

VS

Product company

✓ Why are repeat customers dropping?

```
SELECT customer_id, COUNT(*) FROM orders GROUP BY
customer_id HAVING COUNT(*) > 1;
```

→ **Find out why.**

03 Daily tools

Service company

- Excel and SQL
- Whatever BI tool the client uses
- Client's data, client's rules

VS

Product company

- SQL, all day
- Event data and notebooks (Python)
- In-house dashboards

04 A normal day

Service company

- Client call, then update the report
- Fix a broken file from the client
- Send the weekly deck

VS

Product company

- Check the product metrics
- Dig into a sudden drop
- Read an A/B test with the PM

05

How you grow

Service company

- Many domains early: banking, retail, telecom
- Toward client lead roles

VS

Product company

- Deep in one domain
- Toward senior or product analytics

06 How they hire freshers

Service company

- ✓ Campus drives, aptitude, basics
- ✓ Large fresher intake

→ **Easier door in.**

VS

Product company

- ✓ SQL and case rounds
- ✓ Fewer fresher seats, higher bar

→ **Harder door, deeper work.**

07

Pick it if you...

Service company

- Want variety and a structured start
- Like working with clients

VS

Product company

- Want to own one product's numbers
- Enjoy asking why users do what they do

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